W013711-102226 - California Public Records Request

Message History (3)

On 11/2/2026 8:34:01 AM, San Mateo Public Records Center wrote:

Subject: California Public Records Request :: W013711-102226
Body:
RE: PUBLIC RECORDS REQUEST of October 22, 2026, **Reference # W013711-102226**

Dear Brian C,

The City received the following records request from you on October 22, 2026.

Under the California Public Records Act, I request records concerning four San Mateo Police Department drone flights and six calls for service on the same dates.

The flights are the following, each recorded with the flight purpose "Vacation Check" (times Pacific): 9/28/2026, 1:46 PM to 1:55 PM, flight ID 8e91efd5-f50d-49ee-ba0a-cf11ec29d4df; 9/28/2026, 1:54 PM to 1:59 PM, flight ID e0f51228-b645-4c69-adf4-9e635c117721; 10/12/2026, 1:06 PM to 1:14 PM, flight ID 83f3a107-82e2-4bf3-a9d8-e66871d4a4bf; 10/21/2026, 1:12 PM to 1:21 PM, flight ID 0dcc6002-c5ef-4f82-bf26-97f5c139e13b.

As you are aware, the Department's October 5, 2026 presentation to the City Council on the Real Time Information Center states: "We record every DFR flight from start to finish. That recording preserves a record of the operation that can be reviewed to evaluate how the drone and camera were used." The same presentation lists, under "DFR Accountability: From Launch to Landing," "Camera use documented," "Access audit trail" and "Supervisor/Program Review."

In this request, "the listed flights" means those four flights, and "the listed incidents" means CAD incidents 202609280139, 202609280141, 202610120119, 202610120121, 202610210152 and 202610210153.

Please provide the following:

1. Any warrant, court order or other legal process authorizing any of the listed flights, or authorizing the observation or recording of any location during them.

2. The complete CAD event record for each listed incident: call type and priority, how and when the call was received, all remarks and narrative entries, every unit dispatched or assigned (including any drone or DFR unit), all status timestamps, and the disposition. Also any CAD, RMS or DFR record that links a listed flight to a call for service.

3. For each listed incident, the vacation house check request it came from (an online form submission, a phone intake record or another record), and any record of what the requester was told about how the check would be carried out, including any notice of, consent to or agreement to the use of a drone. Also a blank copy of each request form, web page or intake script in use on those dates. I am not seeking the name, contact information or address of any requester, and those may be redacted.

4. The following, as in effect from 9/28/2026 through 10/21/2026: (a) the Department's "Small Unmanned

Aircraft Systems (sUAS) Procedure," which is listed in the table of contents of the Standard Operating Procedure Manual the Department produced on 4/21/2026 in request W012571-042026; (b) each Policy Manual chapter governing the Department's use of drones; (c) any procedure, order or guideline for vacation house checks; and (d) any written directive, bulletin or training material that addresses using drones for vacation house checks.

5. For each listed flight, the flight record held in Skydio Cloud, the Department's evidence software or any other system: the flight log or flight report, the launch and landing locations, the flight path including altitude, the pilot or operator, the record documenting camera use, any record of who requested or approved the flight, and any supervisor or program review of it.

6. For each listed flight, the recording of the flight and any other video or still images captured, together with the retention category assigned, any record of deletion, and the access audit trail showing each person who viewed, downloaded or shared them. Given the presentation's statement that every flight is recorded from start to finish, a "no responsive records" response to this item would mean that the recording no longer exists or was never made.

If any portion of these records is withheld, I'd ask that it be marked in place with the exemption relied on for that portion, so the remainder can be released (Gov. Code §§ 7922.525(b), 7922.540). Please preserve the video, images and flight records for the listed flights while this request is pending.

Thank you,

Brian

Due to the large number of records which are associated with this request, the City will send you records on a rolling production basis. An initial batch of records has been released and made available on the San Mateo Records Request Portal. You will be receiving more batches of responsive records in the future. Select the link below to view what is currently available.

We will further respond to your request with updates no later than 11/13/2026.

If you have any questions, please contact me using the below contact information.

Sincerely,

Kelly O'Keefe
Police Technical Services Administrator
Police
(650) 522-7709

On 10/22/2026 6:51:07 PM, San Mateo Public Records Center wrote:

Thank you for your interest in public records of the City of San Mateo. Your request was received by the City of San Mateo on 10/22/2026 and given the reference number **W013711-102226** for tracking purposes.

Record(s) Requested: **Under the California Public Records Act, I request records concerning four San Mateo Police Department drone flights and six calls for service on the same dates.**

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Thank you,

Brian

The request is being forwarded to appropriate department(s) for processing.

Monitor request progress at the link below. The City will email you when the request is complete. Thank you for using the San Mateo Records Center.

To monitor the progress or update this request please log into the San Mateo Records Center.

On 10/22/2026 6:51:06 PM, Brian C wrote:

Request Created on Public Portal